



M/J Latin, Beginning

COURSE 0706000 • GRADES 6–8 • TWO SEMESTERS • OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE — FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. It was drawn from one section of the course as taught this year, and each teacher leans into their own strengths and passions — so scholars may see some variation in activities, projects, and pacing from section to section, and between the live school and On-Demand. The structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

What this course is: A full first year of classical Latin for middle schoolers, built on grammar, memory work, English derivatives, and Roman culture. **Semester 1 is the verb semester:** students master the present, imperfect, and future tenses, learn to parse and conjugate, and meet the irregular verb *sum* ("to be"). **Semester 2 is the noun semester:** cases and their "jobs," the first and second declensions, adjectives, questions, and numbers — ending with constellations and a year-end review of every part of speech.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

Mod 0–1	Welcome, the Latin notebook, alphabet & pronunciation
Mod 2–5	Verbs: principal parts, person & number, conjugating, parsing review
Mod 6–10	Imperfect & future tenses; present-system review
Mod 11–13	The verb <i>sum</i> and predicate nominatives; cumulative review week
Mod 14–16	Second conjugation; parsing both conjugations • Semester Exam
Mod 17–21	Nouns have cases: case jobs, first declension, direct objects
Mod 22–25	Second declension (incl. neuter); asking & answering questions
Mod 26–29	Adjectives & agreement; cardinal/ordinal numbers, Roman numerals
Mod 30–34	Constellations + four-week year-end review of verbs, nouns, adjectives & numbers

MEMORABLE EXTRAS

- **Derivative Minute** — each week connects Latin words to the English words they gave us.
- **VR companion lessons** — most Semester-1 modules include an optional immersive VR version of the lesson; Semester 2 features a "Noun Jobs in VR" activity.
- **Student video** — the year-end verb review includes a make-your-own-video assignment.

A TYPICAL WEEK

- **Module introduction** — often with the teacher's famously "cringy" intro video
- **Memory work** — chants and charts for the week's forms
- **"Exploring Latin" lesson** — grammar and culture, taught step by step
- **"Words We Know"** vocabulary + practice assignments (flashcards, conjugation/declension drills)
- **Fun practice** — Gimkit & Blooket review games
- **Module quiz** to close the week

TIME COMMITMENT

≈4 hours per week (250 minutes — about 50 min/day, M–F)

Lessons & memory work ≈1½ hr • vocabulary & written practice ≈1½ hr • review games & quiz ≈1 hr

Per-part split is an estimate; the 250-minute weekly total comes from the school's course plan. Exam and review weeks may run longer.

WHAT STUDENTS NEED

- A computer with access to Canvas; a dedicated **Latin notebook** (set up in Module 0)
- The student workbook (provided as a PDF in the course)
- VR headset for the optional companion lessons (live-school students use VR daily)

On-Demand (asynchronous): This overview describes the self-paced experience the course is designed for — students work through lessons on their own schedule with an Optima teacher available for support, feedback, and grading.

Live school: Students enrolled in the live virtual school take this same course in VR every school day with a teacher and classmates.